

## Maritime hub: On the Vizhinjam port

The Vizhinjam port offers **enormous** economic benefits for India

The **commissioning** of the Vizhinjam International Transshipment Deepwater Multipurpose Seaport, developed by Adani Ports and Special Economic Zone Ltd (APSEZ) under a public-private partnership model with the Kerala government, **marks** a **milestone** in India's **maritime** history. For a country such as India, which **relies** heavily **on** foreign ports for handling around 75% of its **inbound** and **outbound transshipment** cargo, **resulting in** an annual revenue loss of approximately \$200 million-\$220 m, the port presents enormous economic opportunities. Its natural draft of about 20 metres, requiring **minimal capital dredging**, and its **proximity** to international shipping routes linking Europe, West Asia and the Far East — the east-west shipping axis — position it as a strong **contender** to become a transshipment hub. This could potentially bring home a significant portion of Indian cargo transshipment handled by the Singapore, Colombo, Salalah and Dubai ports. Ultra-large container vessels can **berth** without **deviating** from their route, **thereby** saving costs. As India's first semi-automated port **equipped with** remote-controlled **quay cranes** and an AI-powered **vessel** traffic management system, Vizhinjam will significantly reduce vessel **turnaround times**. India's container **throughput** capacity last year was approximately 20 million TEUs (twenty-foot equivalent units), **contrasting with** China's 330 million TEUs. This **highlights** the need for modern ports such as Vizhinjam along India's **coastline**.

**Following** the project's agreement in 2015, the Kerala government faced challenges, including protests from **fisherfolk** supported by the Latin Church, natural **calamities** and the COVID-19 pandemic. Commercial operations **commenced** in July 2024, with 265 ships, including large **mother ships**, having berthed **so far**. In the first phase, the Kerala government invested ₹5,595 crore, Adani Ports spent ₹2,454 crore, and the Union government provided a **viability gap fund loan** of ₹818 crore — a funding structure that **sparked** political **debate**. For Vizhinjam, an all-weather port, to become a game-changer in South Asia's maritime trade, the Centre and the State must ensure the timely completion of rail and road connectivity, which is crucial for **leveraging** the port's full **potential**. This will **facilitate efficient** cargo delivery to the entire **hinterland** of South India. The subsequent development **phases**, for which APSEZ and the Kerala government have signed an agreement involving an investment of around ₹9,500 crore by 2028, **must** also be implemented **promptly**. Warehousing, **logistics**, and industrial facilities are **essential** for the port to **evolve** into a **thriving** commercial maritime hub.

[Practice Exercise]

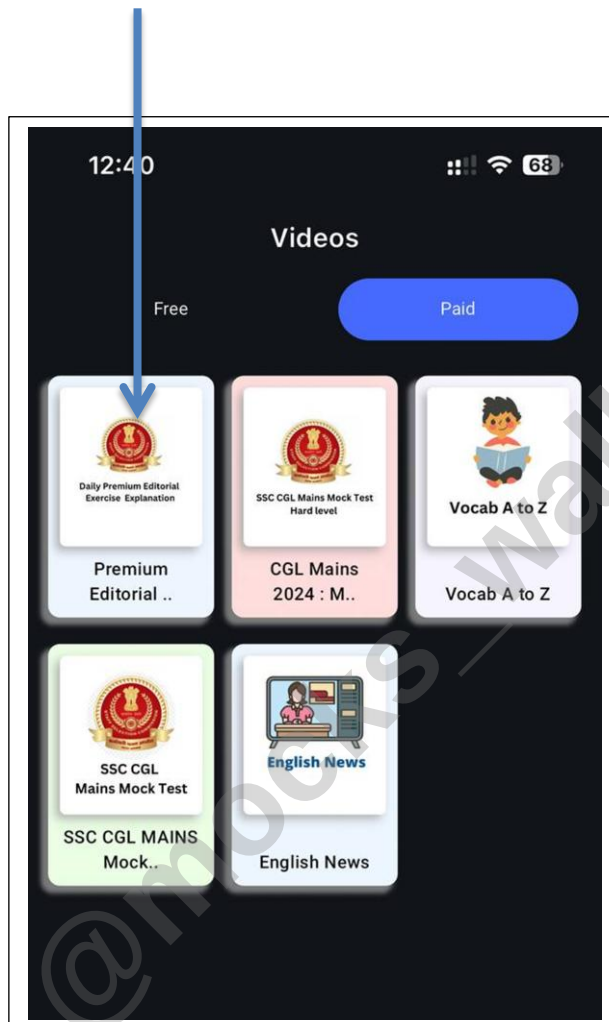
- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.
- **Fisherfolk** (noun) – people who catch fish for a living. मछुआरा

## Vocabulary

1. **Enormous** (adjective) – huge, immense, massive, colossal, gigantic विशाल
2. **Commissioning** (noun) – initiation, launch, activation, inauguration, deployment आरंभ
3. **Mark** (verb) – indicate, signify, represent, denote, commemorate चिह्नित करना
4. **Milestone** (noun) – landmark, achievement, breakthrough, benchmark, turning point मील का पत्थर
5. **Maritime** (adjective) – nautical, naval, sea-related, oceanic, marine समुद्री
6. **Rely** (on) (verb) – depend on, trust, count on, lean on, bank on – निर्भर रहना
7. **Inbound trans-shipment** (noun) – refers to the process of unloading cargo from one vessel and loading it onto another at an intermediate port or location, typically during its journey to the final destination. आगमन माल स्थानांतरण
8. **Outbound transshipment** (noun) – This involves unloading imported containers at a terminal port and loading them onto another vessel for export प्रस्थान माल स्थानांतरण
9. **Result in** (phrasal verb) – cause, lead to, bring about, produce, culminate in परिणामस्वरूप होना
10. **Minimal** (adjective) – least, negligible, small, slight, marginal न्यूनतम
11. **Capital dredging** (noun) – the removal of previously undisturbed seabed to create or expand navigation channels, berths, or other water-related facilities गहराई बढ़ाने की खुदाई
12. **Proximity** (noun) – nearness, closeness, adjacency, vicinity, immediacy निकटता
13. **Contender** (noun) – competitor, rival, candidate, aspirant, challenger दावेदार
14. **Berth** (verb) – dock, anchor, moor, tie up, station जहाज़ लगाना
15. **Deviate** (verb) – diverge, stray, swerve, depart, veer भटकना
16. **Thereby** (adverb) – thus, as a result, hence, accordingly, in doing so इस प्रकार
17. **Equip** (with) (verb) – furnish, provide, supply, outfit, install सुसज्जित करना
18. **Quay crane** (noun) – a large gantry crane used at container terminals to load and unload containers from ships.
19. **Vessel** (noun) – ship, boat, craft, liner, carrier जहाज़
20. **Turnaround time** (noun) – the duration required to complete a task or process from its initiation to its completion

21. **Throughput** (adjective) – processing, handling, capacity-driven, output-related, flow-based संचालन क्षमता से संबंधित
22. **Contrast** (with) (verb) – differ from, compare against, vary from, diverge from, oppose भिन्न होना
23. **Highlight** (verb) – emphasize, underscore, draw attention to, stress, point out जोर देना
24. **Coastline** (noun) – seashore, shore, littoral, waterfront, coast समुद्र तट
25. **Following** (preposition) – after, subsequent to, in the wake of, ensuing, post के बाद
26. **Calamity** (noun) – disaster, catastrophe, misfortune, crisis, tragedy आपदा
27. **Commence** (verb) – begin, start, initiate, launch, embark प्रारंभ करना
28. **Mother ship** (noun) – a large spacecraft or ship from which smaller craft are launched or maintained.
29. **So far** (phrasal verb) – until now, up to this point, as yet, hitherto, till now अब तक
30. **Viability gap fund loan** (noun) – Refers to a government scheme that provides financial support to make infrastructure projects economically viable but commercially unviable. परियोजना सहायता ऋण
31. **Spark** (verb) – trigger, provoke, ignite, incite, cause उत्पन्न करना
32. **Debate** (noun) – discussion, argument, discourse, deliberation, controversy बहस
33. **Leverage** (verb) – utilize, exploit, capitalize on, harness, use effectively लाभ उठाना
34. **Potential** (noun) – capacity, possibility, capability, promise, prospect संभाव्यता
35. **Facilitate** (verb) – ease, assist, promote, help, enable सुविधा प्रदान करना
36. **Efficient** (adjective) – effective, productive, streamlined, well-organized, optimized कुशल
37. **Hinterland** (noun) – interior region, inland area, remote area, backcountry, rural zone आंतरिक इलाके
38. **Promptly** (adverb) – quickly, swiftly, immediately, instantly, without delay तुरंत
39. **Logistics** (noun) – supply chain, transport coordination, operations, freight management, distribution रसद
40. **Essential** (adjective) – necessary, vital, crucial, indispensable, fundamental आवश्यक
41. **Evolve** (into) (verb) – develop, transform, grow, emerge, progress into विकसित होना
42. **Thrive** (verb) – prosper, flourish, succeed, bloom, grow strongly फलना-फूलना

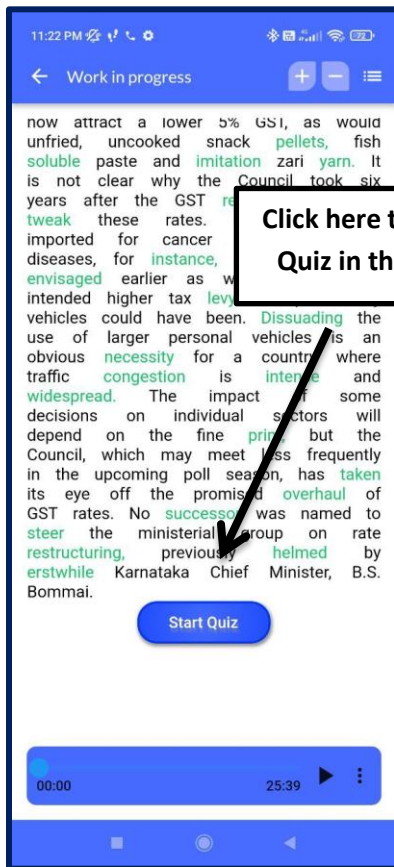
**Video solution of Practice Exercise from this Editorial is exclusively available on App.**



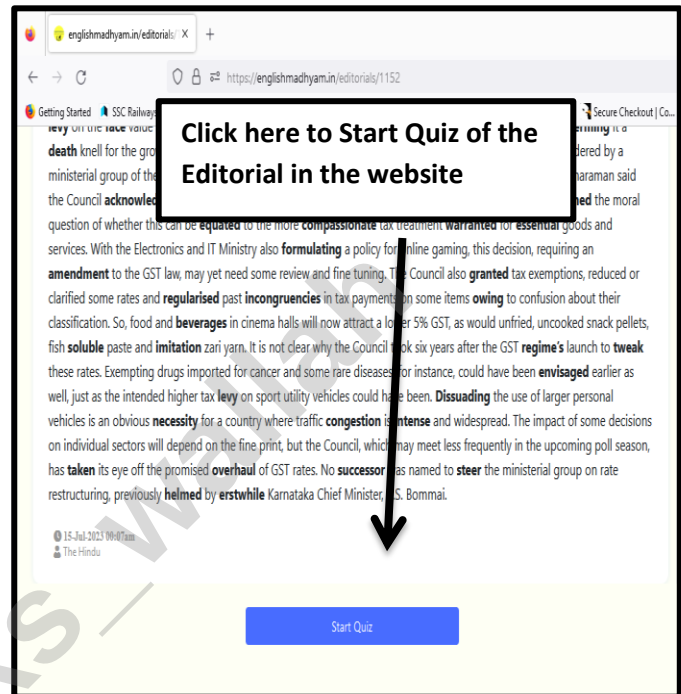
### Summary of the Editorial

1. Vizhinjam Port, developed by Adani Ports under a PPP model with the Kerala government, marks a historic step in India's maritime infrastructure.
2. India currently loses \$200–\$220 million annually due to reliance on foreign ports for 75% of its transshipment cargo.
3. Vizhinjam offers economic benefits by potentially repatriating Indian cargo currently handled by ports in Singapore, Colombo, Salalah, and Dubai.
4. The port features a natural draft of 20 metres, requiring minimal dredging, which is ideal for ultra-large container ships.
5. Its strategic location near major international shipping routes makes it a prime candidate for a transshipment hub.
6. Vizhinjam is India's first semi-automated port, with remote-controlled quay cranes and an AI-powered vessel traffic management system.
7. These features will help reduce vessel turnaround times, increasing operational efficiency.
8. In comparison, India's container handling capacity is just 20 million TEUs versus China's 330 million TEUs, showing the need for modern ports.
9. The project faced delays due to local protests, natural disasters, and the COVID-19 pandemic.
10. Commercial operations began in July 2024, and 265 ships, including mother vessels, have berthed so far.
11. Funding included ₹5,595 crore from Kerala, ₹2,454 crore from Adani Ports, and an ₹818 crore viability gap loan from the Centre.
12. The funding model sparked political controversy, though the port's economic benefits are significant.
13. For full potential, improved rail and road connectivity to the South Indian hinterland is critical.
14. An additional ₹9,500 crore investment is planned by 2028 under a new agreement between APSEZ and the Kerala government.
15. Establishing warehousing, logistics, and industrial infrastructure is key for Vizhinjam to become a major commercial maritime hub.

## Practice Exercise: SSC Pattern Based



Click here to Start  
Quiz in the App



Click here to Start Quiz of the  
Editorial in the website

[Click here to download App](#)

[Click here to visit website](#)



# Learn Vocabulary Through Reading Articles

**English Madhyam**